

on its popularity and the amount of volunteer developer talent it attracts. As such, publicity plays an important role in open source development, with project supporters often using directories such as freshmeat and fsf.org to promote their projects. Projects also gain publicity through articles published in open source developers community journals such as Linux Weekly News and IBM Developerworks.

For more first hand experience with open source projects, you can visit among others, www.sourceforge.net – an online source code repository which has about 1,80,000 projects and over 1.9 million registered developers.

1.4 Limitations of open source.

As with all things in life, open source development comes at a price. While open source development methodologies offer excellent solutions for developing quick, powerful and popularly needed software solutions, it is often insufficient to provide customer specific software development, related consultancy and services. The reliability of the open source development process is also under question as development timelines are notoriously prone to trends in fashion within the open source community, though the final product when produced is found to be often very reliable.

Large amounts of manpower and developer talent are wasted on some projects started new when it would have been more efficient to contribute to a pre-existing project. This effect is known as the not invented here (NIH) syndrome.

In specific areas of software development, pro-proprietary software campaigners argue that the free availability of the source code of open source software makes it easier for users with malicious objectives to find vulnerabilities in the software and exploit it.

Open source software and related businesses have been shown to be relying on a poorly constructed business model. While projects rely largely on volunteer developers and are unpredictable in terms of timelines, the companies are still answerable to their shareholders. The companies that rely on paid developers for their open source development find it difficult to reclaim their development costs through providing support and consultancy alone. Proprietary software based